



WINSTON AND ELEANOR

2017

5 POSTS · 5 PHOTOGRAPHS

JUNE 16 – OCTOBER 19, 2017



JUNE 16, 2017

We've taken so many cute photos here and it seems inappropriate to flood Facebook with them but couldn't resist posting a few from today. Love how even the commute to do fun stuff is fun in itself- we took a river boat and a motorbike to get here, then a sky train and a regular train to get back 🙄 and if you haven't noticed by now, we love pools of all kinds- water, sprinkles, balls, you name it. 🍷



JUNE 30, 2017
LUANG PRABANG, LAOS

#1 rated restaurant in LPB, and extra bonus they have ice cream for the kids while I drink my organic locally sourced latte 🙄 I've had people from all over the world ask me who I'm traveling with and be shocked that I'm by myself with two kids. "How do you do it???" I have no idea, some days they drive me crazy, but it's funny that two kids are difficult, no matter what culture you come from.
PS- we really love Laos!



AUGUST 11, 2017

IT'S OFFICIAL, ELLA CAN SWIM!!!!!!
#3yearsold #proudmama

2017

SEPTEMBER 12, 2017

Recent photos of the kids. They are alive and thriving. The international school I want to put them in is full for the year so instead, they're doing activities and a bit of world schooling which is ideal since we travel frequently. I'd argue that they are learning as much if not more than they would in preschool:

They learned a bit about gravity and physics by throwing rocks, both big and small, into the Laotian section of the Mekong river.

They're identifying and trying new fruits: they particularly like dragonfruit, mangosteen, and starfruit. Ella even tried some durian.

We learned the Mekong river basin is home to some of the largest biodiversity in the world, second only to the amazon

We have tried all forms of transport: tuk tuk, truck back, sky train, underground train, minibus, motorbike, all sorts of boats and ferries, regular bus, plane, and of course cars. They're seasoned travelers and quite easy to bring around.

We got to bathe and walk elephants, hear gibbons sing, Ella snorkeled and saw fish in the ocean for the first time, a wild pack of monkeys stole bananas from their hands and grabbed Ella by her dress.

They're learning about different languages, and regularly greet Thai in the traditional way. They speak some common Thai words we hear with a humorously accurate accent.

They've watched me bargain with vendors and are very good at walking away from things that they really want because they understand there will be more vendors with the same items and we want to buy from a nice person at a good price.

We talk about the value of items and that some things may be cheap, but they are not good quality. They've seen poor quality toys break after minimal use, and that often we would rather buy better quality things for more.

They've found all kinds of beautiful shells on the beaches out there, and have built up quite a collection. We've also seen hermit crabs, frogs, giant lizards, exotic birds, butterflies in all colors, and a myriad of other animals in their natural habitat.

They know the difference between wild animals and pets, and know not to touch the street cats & dogs. We've made some exceptions for puppies.

Winston's exceptionally good at recognizing places we've walked by, such as random restaurants or where we got dropped off. He loves reading maps and often times direct us to places he's been to.

They often pay for their own treats and get the change, we're learning the worth of different bills and coins. Soon I'll give them an allowance to spend as they wish so they can start managing money and decide for themselves if they want to buy something and if it's worth it.

They're learning the names of the MRT stops we go to often, can recognize the names when they're announced, and try to recognize what gates we are at, or what number our room is etc.

They swim almost every day, and we often go on walks to get my morning coffee or to grab lunch. We always discover new things along the way. Winston said he "loves long belaxing walks". Ella has learned how to swim!

They've learned there are good and bad people. We have had one bad experience with someone, but majority of the people we have encountered we've had overwhelmingly positive experiences with. Most of the people here love kids and I like seeing the joy that the kids bring to others. People often follow them and take photos of them and are very helpful.

They each have a backpack that they pack themselves for trips. They're responsible for remembering what to bring, and keeping track of their belongings.

Motor skills- when we got here, Ella couldn't get onto an escalator by herself. Now she can and she's so proud of herself. Winston can open and close various locks (after locking us out w the chain lock at home and not being able to open it!)

Just about the only thing they miss from California is Disneyland. Ella sometimes asks "Can we go to Disneyland today?" I haven't had the heart to tell them there is no Disneyland here.... However, Tokyo, Hong Kong, Shanghai and even Paris is just a flight away and I'm sure we'll make our way to all of them.

So relax, Mom. Kids are doing great!

SEPTEMBER 2017





OCTOBER 19, 2017
KOH SICHANG, THAILAND

When traveling with kids, I basically need one day of rest when we arrive and one day when we get back. But these smiles are priceless 😊